Grounded Escapism

c.ai

Character.AI

18 Million Chatbots
20 Million Daily Users

Data Centers consume 40% of US's electricity by 2030

CO_2 emissions = 10,000,000 cars by 2030

Power demand = 300,000 households by 2027

67% of developing data centres are set in water-lacking areas.

100 future data centers = 10,500 homes

REE Mining projected to spike by 6 times by 2040

1.7 Million GPU chips manufactured in 2024 alone

249 Billion bottles consumed by 2028

Data centres will evaporate 15,000,000 litres of water daily by 2028

82 millions tons of E-waste by 2030

Novelty — First exposure to AI Roleplay

Easy Set-up & Use — No sign ups, No servers

Repeated Routine — Low cognitive load

Habit — Predictable reward loops

Sense of Control

Emotional Attachment — Up to 5+ hours daily

Extremely Long Sessions — 1 session = 5 water

This isn't because it's convenient - it's emotional - and it's planetary grounded

How can we reduce the compulsivity of this pattern?

Key

- Immediate
- Accumulative
- Spike
- Data
- Water Input
- Leachate output
- Trans-pacific network cables